

Probabilistic Modeling and Parameter Estimation

Statistical Foundations of AI and ML, Module 2

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17 September 2024

Introduction to Probabilistic Modeling

Maximum-Likelihood Estimation

Bayesian Approach to Parameter Estimation

Parameter Estimation in Machine Learning Models

Probabilistic Modeling of Data

- ▶ For Machine Learning, we start with data: $\{x_1, x_2, \dots, x_N\}$
we begin with observations
- ▶ The data may be binary, discrete, real-valued, vectors, or mixed
This matters because different data types suggest different probability models.
- ▶ Our aim may be to predict the next measurement (in case of sequential data), or class-labels, or clusters in the data
we want to predict : Predict the next value (time series), Classify something, Group Data (Clustering)
- ▶ This requires a mathematical framework to accommodate the observations
Data alone is not enough. We need a model to describe variability, encode assumptions, and allow inference.
- ▶ Probabilistic Model: imagine the measurements as realizations of random variables $\{X_1, \dots, X_N\}$
Instead of seeing the data as fixed numbers, we imagine : x_i as a Realization of X_i
The data we saw is one outcome.
- ▶ What distributions do these RVs follow?
Many other outcomes are possible, there is an underlying random mechanism generating data

Choosing a distribution is equivalent to proposing a story about how data are generated.

Why probabilistic model?

- ▶ Probabilistic Models allow an elegant modeling of (in)dependence between the observations
- ▶ They provide a *story* of the origin of the data, allow for generation of more data
- ▶ Provides flexibility of model by allowing complex interactions including other latent variables Latent variables = hidden variables.
- ▶ Allow the estimation of unobserved variables using probabilistic inference $P(\text{hidden variable} | \text{observed data})$
- ▶ Allow for uncertainty analysis by specifying ranges of possible values of measurements

Instead of saying: The parameter is 5.

We say: The parameter is probably between 4.7 and 5.3.

Model Design Choices

- ▶ Observations $\{x_1, \dots, x_N\}$ are realizations of RVs $\{X_1, \dots, X_N\}$
- ▶ Need to consider models $P(X_1, \dots, X_N)$
 - 1. Are all these RVs independent?
 - 2. What are their distributions?
 - 3. What are the parameter values of those distributions?
- ▶ Simplest case: Independent and Identically Distributed (IID)
- ▶ $X_i \sim f(\theta)$ where f : distribution, θ : parameter values
- ▶ Independent but NOT identically distributed: $X_i \sim f_i(\theta_i)$, i.e. each variable has its own distribution
- ▶ NOT Independent: specify the joint or conditional distributions!

We must describe the joint distribution over all the variables, this will answer: How likely is any possible dataset?

same generating mechanism each time, No interaction, same params

Probabilistic Model Fitting

- ▶ All models are imagined, no **true** model
- ▶ Some models can fit the data better than other models
- ▶ Each model allows us to define *joint distribution* over RVs
- ▶ Eg. $P_1(\{X_1, \dots, X_N\}) = \prod_{i=1}^N f_i(\theta_i)$ (Independent but not identically distributed)
- ▶ Or $P_2(\{X_1, \dots, X_N\}) = g(X_1, \dots, X_N)$ (not independent)
- ▶ The model for which $P(x_1, \dots, x_N)$ is maximum, is said to fit the data best!
- ▶ Different models may fit different observation sets!

$P(x|\text{model})$ is known as Likelihood, A model that assigns higher probab to observed data fits better

A model that fits one dataset may fail on another, which leads to overfitting, model selection and cross validation.

Fitting a model means evaluating the Joint probab : $P(X_1, X_2, \dots, X_N)$ at the observed data.

Probabilistic Model Fitting

- ▶ Consider observations of 10 tosses $x = \{HHHHHTTTTT\}$
- ▶ Model 1 (M1): All tosses from same coin with bias 0.5
- ▶ Model 2 (M2): First 5 tosses from coin with bias 0.9, remaining tosses from another coin with bias 0.1
- ▶ $P_{M1}(x) = 0.5^{10}$, $P_{M2}(x) = 0.9^{10}$ 0.9¹⁰ >>> 0.5¹⁰ so from pure likelihood perspective the second model wins.
- ▶ Second model fits data better, but first model is **simpler**!
- ▶ Simpler model: fewer parameters, better generalization
- ▶ Model design: trade-off between data fit and simplicity!

Model 1 has only 1 param

Model 2 has more structure, more assumptions , more params

How to choose a Model?

- ▶ Are the observations *independent*?
- ▶ Consider the physics of the problem to get answers
- ▶ If not, carry out statistical tests of independence hypothesis (to be discussed later)
- ▶ Choose nature of distribution for X_i
- ▶ *Support* of the distribution must match that of observations
- ▶ *PDF/PMF* of the distribution must match histogram of observations
- ▶ Statistical testing of Hypothesis should be used (to be discussed later)

Parameter Estimation

- ▶ Question: What are the parameter values of the chosen distribution?
- ▶ Answer: values that cause the distribution to fit the data!
- ▶ Simplest approach: method of moments estimation (MME)
- ▶ The theoretical moments of the distribution must fit the empirical moments

- ▶ Theoretical moments:

$M_t(X) = E(X^t) = \int_{\text{Support}(X)} x^t f_X(x) dx$ where f_X is the PDF of the chosen distribution (analogously for PMF)

draw samples from the experiment, the data which u have, raise to power 't'

- ▶ Empirical moments: $m_t(\{x_1, \dots, x_N\}) = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^N x_i^t$
- ▶ Form T equations like $M_t(X) = m_t(\{x_1, \dots, x_N\})$, and solve simultaneously for the parameters of f_X

if N is large enough then empirical moment tends to theoretical moment

Common Discrete Distributions

For bernoulli distribution, expected value of RV = p , just one param so we need just one eqn to solve.

Distribution	Support	PMF	Parameters
Bernoulli	$\{0, 1\}$	$p^x(1-p)^{(1-x)}$	p
Binomial	$\mathcal{Z}$	$\binom{N}{x} p^x (1-p)^{N-x}$	N, p
Poisson	$\mathcal{Z}$	$\frac{e^{-\lambda} \lambda^x}{x!}$	λ
Geometric	$\mathcal{Z}^+$	$(1-p)^{x-1} p$	p
Categorical	$\{V_1, \dots, V_K\}$	$\prod_{k=1}^K p_k^{I(x=k)}$	$(p_1, p_2, \dots, p_K)$
Multinomial	$\mathcal{Z}^K$	$\frac{N!}{n_1! \dots n_K!} \prod_{k=1}^K p_k^{n_k}$	$(N, p_1, \dots, p_K)$

Common Continuous Distributions

Distribution	Support	PDF	Parameters
Beta	$(0, 1)$	$\frac{1}{B(a, b)} x^{(a-1)} (1-x)^{(b-1)}$	(a, b)
Gamma	$\mathcal{R}_+$	$\frac{\beta^\alpha}{\Gamma(\alpha)} x^{\alpha-1} \exp(-\beta x)$	(α, β)
Gaussian	$\mathcal{R}$	$\frac{1}{\sqrt{(2\pi)\sigma}} \exp(-\frac{1}{2\sigma^2}(x-\mu)^2)$	(μ, σ)
M.V. Gaussian	$\mathcal{R}^D$	$\frac{1}{2\pi^{\frac{D}{2}} \Sigma ^{\frac{1}{2}}} \exp(-\frac{1}{2}(x-\mu)^T \Sigma^{-1}(x-\mu))$	(μ, Σ)

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Maximum Likelihood Estimation (MLE)

- ▶ Choose the parameter values such that joint probability/PDF of the observations is maximized!
- ▶ i.e. Choose parameters so that model fits the data best!
- ▶ Write down joint PMF/PDF of the observations
- ▶ $prob(X_1 = x_1, X_2 = x_2, \dots, X_N = x_N) = \prod_{n=1}^N prob(X_n = x_n)$
- ▶ This is also called **likelihood function** $\mathcal{L}(p)$ of parameters p of the distribution (prob)
- ▶ Choose parameters such that this likelihood is maximized!
- ▶ Differentiate w.r.t p , equate to 0, solve equations!

MLE of Bernoulli

- ▶ Input: results of N tosses, $X_i \in \{0, 1\}$
- ▶ Based on support, we choose Bernoulli Distribution
- ▶ Need to estimate parameter p

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{L}(p) &= \prod_{n=1}^N \text{prob}(X_n = x_n) = \prod_{n=1}^N p^{x_n} (1-p)^{1-x_n} \\ &= p^{N_1} (1-p)^{N_0}\end{aligned}\tag{1}$$

$$p_{MLE} = \text{argmax}_p \mathcal{L}(p) = \frac{N_1}{N_1 + N_0}\tag{2}$$

MLE for Poisson

- ▶ Input: N integer observations, $X_i \in \mathcal{Z}$
- ▶ Based on support and histogram, we may choose Poisson Distribution
- ▶ Need to estimate parameter λ

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{L}(\lambda) &= \prod_{n=1}^N \text{prob}(X_n = x_n) \propto \prod_{n=1}^N e^{-\lambda} \lambda^{x_n} \\ &= e^{-N\lambda} \lambda^{\sum_{n=1}^N x_n}\end{aligned}\quad (3)$$

$$\lambda_{MLE} = \text{argmax}_{\lambda} \mathcal{L}(\lambda) = \frac{\sum_{n=1}^N x_n}{N}\quad (4)$$

MLE for Gaussian

- ▶ Input: N real observations, $X_i \in \mathcal{R}$
- ▶ Based on support and histogram, we may choose Gaussian/Normal Distribution
- ▶ Need to estimate parameter (μ, σ)

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{L}(\mu, \sigma) &= \prod_{n=1}^N \text{prob}(X_n = x_n) \propto \prod_{n=1}^N \frac{1}{\sigma} \exp\left(-\frac{(x_n - \mu)^2}{\sigma^2}\right) \\ &= \frac{1}{\sigma^N} \exp\left(-\sum_{n=1}^N \frac{(x_n - \mu)^2}{\sigma^2}\right) \quad (5)\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}\mu_{MLE}, \sigma_{MLE} &= \text{argmax}_{\mu, \sigma} \mathcal{L}(\mu, \sigma) \\ \mu_{MLE} &= \frac{\sum_{n=1}^N x_n}{N}, \sigma_{MLE} = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{n=1}^N (x_n - \mu_{MLE})^2 \quad (6)\end{aligned}$$

MLE for Multivariate Gaussian

- ▶ Input: N real vector observations, $X_i \in \mathcal{R}^D$
- ▶ Based on support and histogram, we may choose Gaussian/Normal Distribution
- ▶ Need to estimate parameter (μ, Σ)

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{L}(\mu, \Sigma) &= \prod_{n=1}^N \text{prob}(X_n = x_n) \propto \prod_{n=1}^N \frac{1}{|\Sigma|^{\frac{1}{2}}} \exp(-(x_n - \mu)^T \Sigma^{-1} (x_n - \mu)) \\ &= \frac{1}{|\Sigma|^{\frac{N}{2}}} \exp\left(-\sum_{n=1}^N (x_n - \mu)^T \Sigma^{-1} (x_n - \mu)\right)\end{aligned}$$

$$\mu_{MLE}, \Sigma_{MLE} = \text{argmax}_{\mu, \Sigma} \mathcal{L}(\mu, \Sigma)$$

$$\mu_{MLE} = \frac{\sum_{n=1}^N x_n}{N}, \Sigma_{MLE} = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{n=1}^N (x_n - \mu_{MLE})(x_n - \mu_{MLE})^T \quad (8)$$

outer product :

Drawbacks of Maximum Likelihood

- ▶ Gives a single optimal value of parameters instead of feasible range
- ▶ Can give unreliable results when data is less
- ▶ Even with a lot of data, can it give *correct* estimate?
- ▶ Toy experiment: Generate 1000 samples from a Gaussian with known parameters μ, σ^2
- ▶ Select a subset S_1 of 100 samples, and estimate μ as the sample mean
- ▶ Repeat this with another sample S_2 . Do the estimates of μ match?
- ▶ If they don't match, how can we expect to find the right μ by Maximum-Likelihood?

Properties of Estimator

- ▶ Consider T_N , a function of N Random Variables
 $T_N = f(X_1, \dots, X_N)$
- ▶ T_N is called a *statistic* of $\{X_i\}$
- ▶ If it is used to *estimate* any parametric function $g(\theta)$, we call T_N an *estimator* of $g(\theta)$
- ▶ For example, sample mean $\bar{X} = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^N X_i$ is an *estimator* of μ , assuming $X_i \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu, \sigma^2)$
- ▶ T_N is a random variable with associated probability distribution
- ▶ *Bias of estimation*: $E(T_N - g(\theta))$
- ▶ If $E(T_N - g(\theta)) = 0 \forall \theta$, we say T_N is an *unbiased estimator* of $g(\theta)$ what is meaning of for all theta here?

Properties of Estimator

- ▶ Every single value of T_N need not equal $g(\theta)$, even if T_N is unbiased estimator
- ▶ In the Gaussian sample experiment, we need to take the expected value of the different sample means!
- ▶ If $\lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} E(T_N - g(\theta)) = 0$, we say T_N is *asymptotically unbiased*
- ▶ i.e. Given infinite data, we can get unbiased estimate
- ▶ *Consistent Estimator*: $\lim_{N \rightarrow \infty} P(|T_N - g(\theta)| < \epsilon) = 1, \forall \theta$ and $\forall \epsilon > 0$
- ▶ i.e. Every individual estimate is arbitrarily close to $g(\theta)$, if based on large enough sample
- ▶ *Mean Square Error*: $E((T_N - g(\theta))^2)$

Properties of Maximum Likelihood

- ▶ Maximum Likelihood Estimate is always a Consistent Estimator
- ▶ Maximum Likelihood Estimate need not be an unbiased Estimator
- ▶ Maximum Likelihood Estimator for Gaussian Mean parameter is unbiased
- ▶ Maximum Likelihood Estimator for Gaussian Variance parameter is asymptotically unbiased
- ▶ Unbiased estimator of Gaussian Variance $\frac{1}{N-1} \sum_{i=1}^N (X_i - \bar{X})^2$
- ▶ However, the MLE has less Mean Square Error than the unbiased estimate!

Bayesian Parameter Estimation

- ▶ Maximum likelihood estimate - entirely based on data
- ▶ But if data is not reliable?
- ▶ Bayesian approach: we may have some prior beliefs
- ▶ Bayesian approach: combine our prior beliefs with evidence, i.e. data
- ▶ Bayesian approach: keep updating our beliefs as more and more data comes in!

Bayesian Parameter Estimation

- ▶ Consider the parameters as random variables
- ▶ Put a **prior distribution** on the parameters
- ▶ $posterior(param|data) \propto prob(data|param) * prior(param)$
- ▶ $prob(data|param) = \mathcal{L}(param)$ (likelihood function)
- ▶ Difference from MLE - we get a distribution of the parameter instead of single value
- ▶ Maximum A-Posteriori (MAP) estimate:
 $param_{MAP} = \operatorname{argmax}_{param} posterior(param|data)$
- ▶ Expected value of parameter from posterior:
 $param_{Bayes} = E(param|data)$

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Bayesian Parameter Estimation

- ▶ How to choose prior distribution?
 - ▶ Reflect our belief on parameter
 - ▶ Mathematical tractability (posterior should be a valid distribution)
- ▶ Some likelihood functions have conjugate prior
- ▶ Prior and Posterior on parameters should be same distribution with different parameters!
 - ▶ Easy to interpret

Bayesian estimate of Bernoulli Distribution

- ▶ Data: $\{x_1, \dots, x_N\} \in \{0, 1\}$, Model: $X_i \sim \text{Bernoulli}(p)$
- ▶ $p \in (0, 1)$, so $\text{prior}(p) = \text{Beta}(a, b)$
 - ▶ (a, b) hyperparameters - parameters of prior
 - ▶ Assume $a = b$ if no information

$$\begin{aligned} \text{posterior}(p|X) &\propto \prod_{i=1}^N \text{prob}(X_i = x_i|p) * \text{prior}(p) \\ &= p^{N_1}(1-p)^{N_0} * p^{a-1}(1-p)^{b-1} \\ &= p^{N_1+a-1}(1-p)^{N_0+b-1} \end{aligned} \quad (9)$$

- ▶ $\text{posterior}(p) : \text{Beta}(N_1 + a, N_0 + b)$
- ▶ $p_{\text{Bayes}} = \frac{N_1+a}{N+a+b}$ (expection), $p_{\text{MAP}} = \frac{N_1+a-1}{N+a+b-2}$ (mode)

Bayesian estimate of Bernoulli parameters

- ▶ $prior(p) = \text{Beta}(5, 7)$, $p_{MAP} = 4/10$
- ▶ $X_1 = \text{TAIL}$, $posterior(p) = \text{Beta}(5, 8)$, $p_{MAP} = 4/11$
- ▶ $X_2 = \text{HEAD}$, $posterior(p) = \text{Beta}(6, 8)$, $p_{MAP} = 5/12$
- ▶ $X_3 = \text{HEAD}$, $posterior(p) = \text{Beta}(7, 8)$, $p_{MAP} = 6/13$
- ▶ $X_4 = \text{TAIL}$, $posterior(p) = \text{Beta}(7, 9)$, $p_{MAP} = 6/14$
- ▶ $X_5 = \text{HEAD}$, $posterior(p) = \text{Beta}(8, 9)$, $p_{MAP} = 7/15$
- ▶ $X_6 = \text{HEAD}$, $posterior(p) = \text{Beta}(9, 9)$, $p_{MAP} = 8/16$

Bayesian estimate of Gaussian Distribution - variance known

- ▶ Data: $\{x_1, \dots, x_N\} \in \mathcal{R}$, Model: $X_i \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu, \sigma^2)$
- ▶ $\mu \in \mathcal{R}$, so $prior(\mu) = \mathcal{N}(\mu_0, \sigma_0^2)$
- ▶ Assume σ is known for simplicity

$$\begin{aligned} posterior(\mu|X) &\propto \prod_{i=1}^N prob(X_i = x_i|\mu) * prior(\mu) \\ &= \frac{1}{\sigma^N} \exp\left(-\frac{\sum_{i=1}^N (x_i - \mu)^2}{2\sigma^2}\right) * \frac{1}{\sigma_0} \exp\left(-\frac{(\mu - \mu_0)^2}{2\sigma_0^2}\right) \\ &= \mathcal{N}\left(\frac{\frac{N}{\sigma^2} \hat{X} + \frac{\mu_0}{\sigma_0^2}}{\frac{N}{\sigma^2} + \frac{1}{\sigma_0^2}}, \frac{1}{\frac{N}{\sigma^2} + \frac{1}{\sigma_0^2}}\right) \end{aligned} \quad (10)$$

where $\hat{X} = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^N X_i$

Bayesian estimate of Gaussian Distribution - Variance Unknown

- ▶ Data: $\{x_1, \dots, x_N\} \in \mathcal{R}$, Model: $X_i \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu, \tau)$ where $\tau = \frac{1}{\sigma^2}$
- ▶ Define $prior(\mu, \tau) = prior_1(\mu|\tau), prior_2(\tau)$
- ▶ $prior_1(\mu|\tau) = \mathcal{N}(\mu_0, \eta\tau)$, $prior_2(\tau) = Gamma(a, b)$
- ▶ $posterior(\mu, \tau) = \mathcal{L}(\mu, \tau, X) * prior_1(\mu|\tau) * prior_2(\tau)$
- ▶ $posterior(\mu) = \int posterior(\mu, \tau) d\tau : GaussianDistribution$
- ▶ $posterior(\tau) = \int posterior(\mu, \tau) d\mu : GammaDistribution$

Confidence Interval of Estimation

- ▶ Sometimes we may not be able to have a point estimate of parameter θ
- ▶ Consider two statistics $U(X)$ and $L(X)$, within which we expect the target θ to lie
- ▶ If $P_{\theta}(\theta \in (L(X), U(X))) = 1 - \alpha$, then $(L(X), U(X))$ is the $100(1 - \alpha)\%$ confidence interval for θ
- ▶ Example: $X_i \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu, \sigma^2)$, then $\bar{X} \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu, \frac{\sigma^2}{n})$
- ▶ So, $P(\mu - \frac{\sigma}{\sqrt{n}}Z_{\alpha/2} < \bar{X} < \mu + \frac{\sigma}{\sqrt{n}}Z_{\alpha/2}) = 1 - \alpha$, where $\Phi(-Z_{\alpha/2}) = \alpha/2$ and $\Phi(Z_{\alpha/2}) = 1 - \alpha/2$
- ▶ Thus $(\bar{X} - \frac{\sigma}{\sqrt{n}}Z_{\alpha/2}, \bar{X} + \frac{\sigma}{\sqrt{n}}Z_{\alpha/2})$ is the $100(1 - \alpha)\%$ confidence interval for μ

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Naive Bayes Classifier as Parameter Estimation

- ▶ Dataset: $\{x_i, y_i\}_{i=1}^N$ where $y_i \in \{1, \dots, C\}$
- ▶ x_i has D discrete-valued features x_{ij} , s.t. $x_{ij} \in \{1, \dots, M_j\}$
- ▶ Bayesian Classifier: X, Y jointly distributed random variables!
- ▶ Prior distribution on label: $Y \sim \text{Cat}(\pi)$ ($\pi = \{\pi_1, \dots, \pi_C\}$)
- ▶ Naive-Bayes model: $P(X|Y) = \prod_{j=1}^D P(X_j|Y)$
- ▶ Class-conditional distribution: $P(X_j|Y = c) \sim \text{Cat}(\theta_{cj})$
 (parameters specific to feature and class label)
- ▶ Joint distribution

$$P(X, Y) = \prod_{i=1}^N P(X_i, Y_i) = \prod_{i=1}^N P(X_i|Y_i)P(Y_i)$$
- ▶ Substituting the PMFs, $P(X, Y) =$

$$\prod_{i=1}^N \prod_{c=1}^C \prod_{j=1}^D \prod_{k=1}^{M_j} \theta_{cjk}^{I(X_{ij}=k)I(Y_i=c)} \prod_{i=1}^N \prod_{c=1}^C \pi_c^{I(Y_i=c)}$$

Naive Bayes Classifier with Dirichlet Prior

- ▶ Maximum-likelihood estimate of θ_{cj} and π : MLE of categorical
- ▶ $\pi_{MLE}(c) = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^N I(Y_i=c)}{\sum_{i=1}^N \sum_{c=1}^C I(Y_i=c)} = \frac{N_c}{N}$ (fraction of examples from class c)
- ▶ $\theta_{MLE}(cjk) = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^N I(X_{ij}=k)I(Y_i=c)}{\sum_{i=1}^N \sum_{k=1}^{M_j} I(X_{ij}=k)I(Y_i=c)} = \frac{N_{cjk}}{N_c}$ (fraction of examples in class c for which j -th feature has value k)
- ▶ For Bayesian analysis, we may put Dirichlet priors
- ▶ $\pi \sim Dir(\alpha)$ and $\theta_{cj} \sim Dir(\beta_{cj})$
- ▶ $P(\theta, \pi | \mathcal{D}) \propto P(\mathcal{D} | \theta, \pi) P(\theta) P(\pi)$ where $\mathcal{D} = \{x_i, y_i\}_{i=1}^N$
- ▶ $P(\pi | \mathcal{D}) = Dir(N_1 + \alpha_1, \dots, N_C + \alpha_C)$
- ▶ $P(\theta_{cj} | \mathcal{D}) = Dir(N_{cj1} + \beta_{cj1}, \dots)$

Linear Regression as Parameter Estimation

- ▶ Data $\{x_i, y_i\}_{i=1}^N$ where $X_i \in \mathcal{R}^D$ and $Y_i \in \mathcal{R}$
- ▶ Linear Regression model: $y_i = W^T x_i$ where $W \in \mathcal{R}^D$
- ▶ Ordinary Least Square estimate:
$$W_{OLS} = \underset{W}{\operatorname{argmin}} \sum_{i=1}^N (y_i - W^T x_i)^2$$
- ▶ Probabilistic model: $Y_i = W^T x_i + \epsilon_i$, where $\epsilon_i \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2)$
- ▶ Equivalently, $Y_i \sim \mathcal{N}(W^T x_i, \sigma^2)$ Y_i is the RV random noise
- ▶ The OLS estimate is equal to Maximum Likelihood estimate!
- ▶ But can we use prior knowledge about W to encourage structural properties?

Ridge Regression

- ▶ Knowledge: W is centered around origin, most likely within a sphere of radius 3ρ
- ▶ Prior $W \sim \mathcal{N}(0^D, \rho^2 I)$ where I is $D \times D$ identity matrix and 0^D is D -dim zero-vector
- ▶ In general, $W \sim \mathcal{N}(W_0, V_0)$
- ▶ Posterior distribution on W : $p(W|\mathcal{D}) = p(\mathcal{D}|W)p(W)$
- ▶ Note: Likelihood $p(\mathcal{D}|W)$ and prior $p(W)$ are both Gaussian!
- ▶ Multiplying PDFs, posterior PDF $\mathcal{N}(W_N, V_N)$ where
$$W_N = V_N V_0^{-1} W_0 + \frac{1}{\sigma^2} V_N \sum_{i=1}^N X_i^T Y_i,$$
$$V_N = (V_0^{-1} + \frac{1}{\sigma^2} \sum_{i=1}^N X_i X_i^T)^{-1}$$

WE can put some gaussian prior over W and posterior will again turn out to be gaussian

Prediction using Linear Regression

- ▶ Aim: given training data $\mathcal{D}$, make predictions on test data x
- ▶ $p(Y|X, \mathcal{D}) = \int p(Y|X, W)p(W|\mathcal{D})dW$ (last term is the posterior)
- ▶ $p(Y|X, W) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{(2\pi)\sigma}} \exp(-\frac{1}{2\sigma^2}(Y - W^T X)^2),$
 $p(W|\mathcal{D}) = \frac{1}{(2\pi)^{D/2} |V_N|^{1/2}} \exp(-0.5(W - W_N)^T V_N^{-1}(W - W_N))$
- ▶ **Theorem:** If $y|x \sim \mathcal{N}(Ax + b, \Sigma)$ and $x \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu_x, \Sigma_x)$, then $x|y \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu_{x|y}, \Sigma_{x|y})$ and $y \sim \mathcal{N}(\mu_y, \Sigma_y)$
- ▶ Here, $\mu_{x|y} = \Sigma_{x|y}(A^T \Sigma^{-1}(y - b) + \Sigma_x^{-1} \mu_x),$
 $\Sigma_{x|y} = (\Sigma_x^{-1} + A^T \Sigma^{-1} A)^{-1}, \mu_y = A \mu_x + b, \Sigma_y = \Sigma + A \Sigma_x A^T$
- ▶ Thus, $Y|X, \mathcal{D} \sim \mathcal{N}(W_N^T X, \sigma^2 + X^T V_N X)$

Sparse Regression with Slab-and-Spike Prior

- ▶ Suppose we want W to be a sparse vector
- ▶ $W = V \circledast \eta$, where η is a binary vector that indicates which elements of W are 0 (slabs and spikes)
- ▶ Then $V \sim \mathcal{N}(0^D, \rho^2 I)$, and $\eta_d \sim \text{Ber}(\eta_0)$
- ▶ Posterior $p(W|\mathcal{D}) \propto p(\mathcal{D}|W)p(V)p(\eta)$
- ▶ The log-PDF: $-\frac{1}{2\sigma^2} \sum_{i=1}^N (y_i - \sum_{j=1}^D \eta_j V_j X_{ij})^2 - \frac{1}{2\rho^2} \sum_j V_j^2 + (\sum_{j=1}^D \eta_j) \log(\eta_0) + (D - (\sum_{j=1}^D \eta_j)) \log(1 - \eta_0)$ where $\sum_{j=1}^D \eta_j$ is the number of non-zero elements
- ▶ Clearly, the posterior does not belong to any standard distribution family
- ▶ MAP estimate: maximize the posterior by co-ordinate ascent approach (alternating maximization) over η_j and V_j

Sparse Regression with LASSO

- ▶ $W_{sparse} = \operatorname{argmin}_W \sum_{i=1}^N (y_i - W^T X_i)^2 + \lambda \|W\|_0$
- ▶ Non-convex, so we relax
 $W_{lasso} = \operatorname{argmin}_W \sum_{i=1}^N (y_i - W^T X_i)^2 + \lambda \|W\|_1$
- ▶ LASSO (least absolute shrinkage and selection operator) works as below

Algorithm 13.1: Coordinate descent for lasso (aka shooting algorithm)

```

1 Initialize  $w = (X^T X + \lambda I)^{-1} X^T y$ ;
2 repeat
3   for  $j = 1, \dots, D$  do
4      $a_j = 2 \sum_{i=1}^n x_{ij}^2$ ;
5      $c_j = 2 \sum_{i=1}^n x_{ij} (y_i - w^T x_i + w_j x_{ij})$ ;
6      $w_j = \operatorname{soft}(\frac{c_j}{a_j}, \frac{\lambda}{a_j})$ ;

```

Sparse Regression with Laplace Prior

- ▶ Bayesian analogy: consider a Laplace prior on W
- ▶ $Lap(W_j|0, \frac{1}{\gamma}) = \frac{\gamma}{2} \exp(-\gamma|W_j|)$ (encourages W_j to be 0)
- ▶ Posterior cannot be computed directly, so need to use alternative expression of PDF called Gaussian Scale Model
- ▶ Joint PDF
$$p(\mathcal{D}, W) \propto \exp(-\frac{1}{2} \sum_{i=1}^N (y_i - W^T x_i)^2) \exp(-\frac{1}{2} W^T D_\lambda W)$$
- ▶ Here, D_λ is a diagonal matrix
- ▶ In general, $X \sim Lap(\mu, \beta) \rightarrow f_X(x) = \frac{1}{2\beta} \exp(-\frac{|x-\mu|}{\beta})$
- ▶ μ analogous to Gaussian Mean/Mode, β analogous to Gaussian variance

Autoregressive Models

- ▶ What if the observations cannot be considered as independent?
- ▶ Factorize as $p(X) = p(X_1)p(X_2|X_1) \dots p(X_i|X_1, \dots, X_{i-1}) \dots$
- ▶ Define $X_i = f(X_1, \dots, X_{i-1})$ where f is a suitable stochastic function
- ▶ Autoregressive model of order k :
 $X_t \sim g(W_1X_{t-1} + \dots + W_kX_{t-k}) + \epsilon_t$ where $\epsilon_t \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2)$
- ▶ If g is identity function, then $X_t \sim \mathcal{N}(W^T X_t^k, \sigma^2)$ where $X_t^k = \{X_{t-1}, \dots, X_{t-k}\}$
- ▶ Parameters may be estimated by Maximum-Likelihood (how?)